# Scholarship Rules 2026

## 1. Overview of Scholarship Programs

Northbridge University offers three institutional scholarship programs: the Merit Scholarship, the Need-Based Grant and the Athletic (Sports) Scholarship. All programs are administered by the Office of Student Finance.

The Merit Scholarship recognizes outstanding academic performance and is worth between $5,000 and $7,500 per academic year depending on the award tier. The Need-Based Grant provides up to $8,000 per academic year to students with demonstrated financial need. The Athletic Scholarship is awarded by the Athletics Department to varsity athletes and is worth between $3,000 and $10,000 per academic year.

The application deadline for the Merit Scholarship and the Need-Based Grant is March 31 each year. Decisions are communicated by May 15. Awards are paid in two equal installments, one per semester.

## 2. Merit Scholarship - Eligibility Requirements

To be eligible for the Merit Scholarship a student must meet ALL of the following requirements:

(a) Enrollment: the student must be enrolled full-time, meaning at least 12 credits per semester.

(b) Year of study: the student must be in year 2, 3 or 4 of an undergraduate program. First-year students are not eligible for the Merit Scholarship; they are automatically considered for the Entrance Award instead.

(c) Academic standing: the student must have a cumulative GPA of at least 3.5 on a 4.0 scale.

(d) Conduct: the student must have no record of academic misconduct.

Meeting the requirements does not guarantee an award if funds are exhausted, but every eligible applicant who applies before the deadline is ranked by GPA.

## 3. Merit Scholarship - Award Tiers

Eligible students are placed in exactly one award tier based on cumulative GPA:

Gold tier: cumulative GPA of 3.85 or higher - $7,500 per academic year.

Silver tier: cumulative GPA from 3.70 up to 3.84 - $6,000 per academic year.

Bronze tier: cumulative GPA from 3.50 up to 3.69 - $5,000 per academic year.

Tier placement is re-evaluated at every annual renewal.

## 4. Need-Based Grant

The Need-Based Grant is available to students whose annual household income is below $60,000.

Applicants must hold a cumulative GPA of at least 2.5 and may be enrolled full-time or part-time, with a minimum of 6 credits per semester.

Applicants must submit the Financial Circumstances Form together with proof of household income. The grant amount (up to $8,000) is determined on a sliding scale according to household income.

Unlike the Merit Scholarship, the Need-Based Grant is open to first-year students.

## 5. Combining Awards (Stacking Rules)

A student may hold at most two institutional awards at the same time.

A student who holds an Athletic (Sports) Scholarship may also receive the Merit Scholarship only if the Athletic Scholarship is worth less than $5,000 per academic year. Students whose Athletic Scholarship is $5,000 or more per year are not eligible to receive the Merit Scholarship in the same year.

The combined value of all institutional awards may not exceed the student's annual tuition of $24,000. If it would, the Need-Based Grant is reduced first.

## 6. Renewal, Revocation and Appeals

The Merit Scholarship is renewable each year provided the student maintains a cumulative GPA of at least 3.3 and remains enrolled full-time. A student whose GPA falls below 3.3 loses the scholarship for the following year but may re-apply once the GPA is 3.5 or higher.

Any scholarship may be revoked for a finding of academic misconduct.

Students may appeal a scholarship decision to the Scholarship Committee within 14 days of the decision. The appeal procedure is described in the Student Services Guide.